Louisa County Water Authority
Board of Directors
February 14, 2024

MEMBERS PRESNET:

MEMBERS ABSENT:

OTHERS PRESNET:

A. Call to Order

Chairman Foster called the meeting to order at __:__ pm.

1. ADOPTION OF THE AGENDA

Chairman Foster asked if there were any changes or additions to the agenda. Ms. Baughman asked to add a closed session for the purpose of discussion of personnel matters. Mr. _____ made a motion to adopt the agenda as amended. The motion was seconded by Mr. _____ and carried __-__.

B. Presentations

C. Citizen Information

D. Consent Agenda

2. APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES:

A. JANUARY 10, 2024 – REGULAR BUSINESS MEETING

3. TREASURER'S REPORT:

A. O & M REPORT / CAPITAL REVENUE & EXPENDITURES REPORT– JANUARY 2024
B. APPROVAL OF DISBURSEMENTS – JANUARY 2024
C. CONSTRUCTION FUND – JANUARY 2024
D. SUMMARY STATEMENT OF REVENUE
E. DETAILED STATEMENT OF REVENUE
F. SUMMARY STATEMENT OF EXPENSES
G. DETAILED STATEMENT OF EXPENSES
H. INVESTMENTS
I. REGIONAL SEWER EXPENSE AND REVENUE
J. NORTHEAST CREEK – PAID CONNECTION FEES AND ALLOCATIONS
K. ZION CROSSROADS – PAID CONNECTION FEES AND ALLOCATIONS

Upon completion of the review and discussion of the Consent Agenda, Treasurer's Report and Second Quarter Statements, Mr. _____ made a motion to approve the Consent Agenda, Treasurer's Report and Second Quarter Statements as presented. The motion was seconded by Mr. _____ and carried __-__.

E. Old Business

4. UPDATE – JAMES RIVER WATER PROJECT

The project is reaching a critical point to have the Army Corps of Engineering permit issued. The spring financing pool deadline is April 15, 2024. The financing will not be issued until the Corps permit has been issued. If the spring financing pool is missed, the summer pool will not be issued until August, causing significant delays, again. The Application and all documentation have been submitted, but the bottom line is no permit – no financing. The two County Administrators are looking at bridge financing in the event the Corps permit has not been issued by the financing deadline of April 15th. Based on the conversation today, it is likely the Corps permit will not be issued until late April or early May, missing the funding pool deadline.

A conditional permit is allowed by the Corps regulations, it is not allowed by the Department of Historic Resources and therefore is an unlikely option to move forward. As a reminder, all documentation was submitted to the Corps in March of 2023. No movement or comments were received until November 2023, and that was only after congressional representatives got involved (Good and Spanberger).

On February 26, 2024, the tree removal work will begin. Since the Corps permit has not been issued, the trees will be cut down instead of pushed over with equipment. The reason to proceed is to get the trees on the ground prior to the nesting season of the long-eared bat, which begins April 1st. After April 1st, tree removal would be pushed back to the end of the nesting season, causing further delays.

A contract in the amount of $39M has been executed for the completion of the JRWA intake, pump station and approximately four miles of raw water line.

Critical timeline –

This week a 30-day review period will begin.
After the first of March 2024, interested parties will meet to discuss any comments received mid-comment period.
Mid-March all comments will be received.
Respond to the comments.
Another 15-day review period will begin. Possibly ending March 30-31.

5. NORTHEAST CREEK WATER TREATMENT PLANT

A. NECWTP SEDIMENTATION BASINS IMPROVEMENTS (SLUDGE-VAC-SYSTEM) UPDATE

The Request for Proposal is currently being advertised. The final funding request has been made to the County of Louisa.

B. 4th OPERATOR

An interview was conducted the first week of February and an offer made. The candidate accepted the offer today.

C. SHOWER REPLACEMENT

Nothing new to report. Currently seeking alternate proposals.

D. DECKING ON GENERATOR

The footers and access slabs have been poured. Once the weather breaks, staff will look at options to construct the decking to allow access to the generator safely.

6. ZION CROSSROADS WELL SYSTEM UPDATES

A. SPRING CREEK #1 & #2

The interior piping and pipe coating was scheduled for completion February 9, 2024, only to discover that the meters provided will not work with the SCADA system. Core & Main has been contacted to provide a meter and Fortiline will take the meter that does not work back for a full refund. We are verifying that the proposed meters from Core & Main will work with our SCADA system and hope to have them ordered by the end of the week. When the meters arrive and are installed and connected to the SCADA system; we have the interior pipe coating and two concrete pads to pour before scheduling the final inspection with the Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water.

B. GREEN SPRINGS WELL #2 PUMP / MOTOR REPLACEMENT

Installation of the new pump / motor for Green Springs Well #2 took place on Monday, February 12, 2024. Green Springs Well #2's pump and motor were original when the well was placed into service and the only pump / motor not replaced in the well system.

On Sunday, February 11, 2024, Spring Creek #3's motor locked up. The pump / motor was pulled, and the new motor installed on Wednesday, February 14, 2024. A backup pump / motor will be ordered for inventory this week.

7. LOUISA REGIONAL WWTP

A. BLOWER

The new blower and been received and staff are working to complete the installation. The old blower will be repaired and placed into inventory to prevent lengthy outages in the future.

B. WATER LEAK

The water leak is isolated and only leaks when the line is in use.

C. INFLUENT PUMP REPAIRS

The influent pump preventative maintenance and needed repairs have been completed. This will allow staff to bring on the old clarifiers as part of the recommendations from the Optimization Study to improve the treatment process.

8. ZION CROSSROADS WWTP

A. LIGHTNING STRIKE

There is one item yet to address, some repairs to the low voltage controls. Some of the insurance money has finally arrived.

B. WATSON MARLOW PUMP REPLACEMENT

Staff at the Zion Crossroads WWTP have been trying to get some pumps repaired. The sales representative reached out to state that the current pumps have been obsolete for at least five years and parts can no longer be ordered for them. Two pumps are currently non-functioning and the remaining two are not functioning properly. Staff is proposing to purchase a new pump every quarter for the next year to replace our current pumps at a cost not to exceed $12,145. Staff is working to get that cost down.

The Board discussed the options and upon completion of the discussion, Mr. _____ made a motion to approve the purchase of a new pump every quarter for the next year to replace the current, obsolete pumps. The motion was seconded by Mr. _____ and carried __-__.

C. CROSSING POINTE PUMP STATION

The operators of the Get-Captive lagoon system behind the UVA Dialysis Center would like to pump the lagoons down through our collection system. They have been informed of the conditions that staff feel comfortable accepting the water from the lagoons. The sludge will need to be pumped and hauled to the Louisa Regional WWTP or Rivanna Water and Sewer Authority. We do not have the capability of taking sludge at the Zion Crossroads WWTP.

9. UPDATE – NEW BRIDGE WWTP

A. BOOSTER PUMP

The booster pump is scheduled to be replaced on or about February 29, 2024. We will notify customers of the possibility of being out of service during that time, but do not expect a complete loss of service during the repair.

B. COSTS TO DATE BREAKDOWN

Did not have completed prior to the distribution of the packets.

C. DEPARTMENT OF WILDLIFE RESOURCES

Buoys and signs were delivered today. Working on a game plan for installation. Need to purchase 6 15-foot pipes for installation. A determination of additional buoys or signage will be made after installation of what was required.

D. NEW BRIDGE EXPENDITURES

Same as item B – will remove one from next agenda.

E. SIGN

A decision on the land installed sign will be made once the buoys and required signage has been completed.

F. LAKE ANNA PLAZA TOWNHOMES

A meeting was conducted on February 12, 2023, to discuss the connection of 30 additional townhomes to the New Bridge Water and Wastewater Systems. The Authority is struggling with compliance with wastewater treatment, there are concerns about the adequacy of the collection and distribution system and staff is concerned with the trend of water use with the addition of the 14 townhomes agreed to be added prior to the Authority taking over operations. The peaking factor during the summer is of great concern to staff.

G. FINAL FILTER RENTAL

The Board discussed the final filter options to regain compliance at the New Bridge Wastewater Treatment Plant.

10. LEAD SERVICE LINE INVENTORY

Progress continues toward the completion of the administrative work of the Lead Service Line Inventory. It appears that less than 60 sites will need to be field inspected, and we are beginning to narrow that amount down further.

11. NORTHEAST CREEK DAM (SOUTH ANNA DAM #22) AND BOWLERS MILL DAM (SOUTH ANNA #2)

A. APPLICATION FOR FUNDING (NORTHEAST CREEK DAM)

The application has been submitted and returned for additional information.

B. LOW LEVEL VALVES – EXERCISE

The Board reviewed the proposal from Bander Smith to be onsite with divers for the low-level valve exercise in the Spring of 2024 (tentatively scheduled for the first week of April, weather dependent). The Board was reminded that the costs associated with Bowlers Mill Dam would be reimbursed by the County of Louisa.

Upon completion of the review, Mr. _____ made a motion to authorize the low-level valve exercise work in the amount of $5,950 for Northeast Creek Reservoir (South Anna #22) and $5,950 for Bowlers Mill Dam (South Anna #2). Mr. _____ seconded the motion and carried __-__.

12. ADDITION OF WATER TO ST. FRANCIS PUMP STATION

A. TOWN OF MINERAL APPROVAL

We have a verbal approval from the Town of Mineral, still waiting for a written approval. Also waiting for Central Virginia Contractors schedule to clear.

13. UTILITY STANDARDS

The Town of Louisa has been contacted regarding their interest in participating, but they have not responded yet.

14. DISCUSSION – DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER JOB DESCRIPTION

The Deputy General Manager's job description has been updated and included in the agenda. Additional, research on the pay range was included in the packet for discussion.

15. DISCUSSION – LOUISA COUNTY WATER AUTHORITY – APPRENTICESHIP PROGRAM

The candidate interviewed and participated in a tour of the Regional Wastewater Treatment Plant and the Northeast Creek Water Treatment Plant. Once staff got together to discuss, it was determined that the candidate wasn't a great fit and did not want weekend or holiday work. This experience felt completely rushed. The General Manager and Human Resources will work on reestablishing the program and hope to launch it fully in August when school begins.

16. DISCUSSION – BANKING SERVICES RFP

The Banking Services RFP is currently out for bid. Once the bid closes, proposers will be evaluated, interviews will be conducted, and a banking services provider will be selected.

17. DISCUSSION – BOARD OF DIRECTORS COMPENSATION

At the January 10, 2024, the Board discusses the Board of Directors compensation. The General Manager was directed to conduct further research. Mr. Dale Mullen, Interim County Attorney suggested reviewing the Louisa County Water Authority Bylaws. The Bylaws state, "Members of the Board shall receive such compensation as shall be fixed from time to time by resolution of the Louisa County Board of Supervisors."

18. ZION CROSSROADS CAR WASH

Staff met via Zoom with the Department of Environmental Quality and the owners of the Car Wash met to discuss the possibility of the car wash connecting to the effluent line. When the meeting was over, DEQ sent an email state their acceptance of the proposal.

Looking into the matter more closely, staff realized this would be a much bigger project for the Authority than originally realized. The General Manager sent an email to DEQ listing the concerns. DEQ responded that they would discuss further internally and respond when they decided on whether we could proceed or not.

F. New Business

G. Reports

H. General Manager's Report

● **January levels**: At the end of January 2024 the static well levels were up 4.46 feet from the end of December 2023 levels. From January 2023 to January 2024, the well levels are up approximately .34 of a foot.

The smaller table shows static well levels located nearer to the production wells. These levels are down approximately 4.20 feet at the end of January 2024 from the end of December 2023 levels. From January 2023 to January 2024, the well levels are up approximately 9.26 feet.

As of February 11,2024, the Department of Environmental Quality Drought website is indicating normal conditions exist for precipitation, groundwater, reservoir levels, and stream flow. The drought watch had been lifted for the Northern Piedmont Region.

● In observance of President's Day, the Louisa County Water Authority business office will be closed on Monday, February 19, 2024.

● The General Manager's term on the Virginia Rural Water Association's Board of Directors is ending in April. Before seeking reelection, the General Manager wanted to confirm with the Board their approval.

● The Auditor sent the following statement, "We issued an unmodified (clean) audit opinion on the financial statements of the LCWA for the year ended June 30, 2023. In addition, we reported no material weaknesses or significant deficiencies in our Government Audit Standards report on Internal Control and on Compliance and Other Matters. The total net position of the LWA was $25,132,906 at 06/30/23 compared to $25,359,574 on 06/30/22. Of the total net position $1,603,884 and $1,582,892 was unrestricted at 06/30/23 and 06/30/22 respectively. The total net position decreased in FY23 by $226,668 compared to an increase in net position in FY22 of $82,072.

● The current past-due listing is down to $7,394.87 from the past-due listing provided in the General Manager's Report, which reported the past-due balance of $8,815.57.

● Mr. Barnes**,** Louisa County Board of Supervisors asked the General Manager to obtain a price to paint or clean the 2 million gallon finished water tank at the Ferncliff Water Treatment Plant. The budgetary cost given from our tank maintenance service provider was $13,150. They have stated that the actual cost to provide the service would be around $12,000. Mr. Barnes suggested a local power washing company. Chris will be meeting them onsite Thursday February 15, 2024, at 11:00 am. Additionally, the General Manager has requested a price for rolling that tank into our current contract.

● The General Manager is no longer required to provide quarterly updated to the Board of Supervisors in person but is required to provide a monthly report. The January report was provided to the Board of Directors.

I. Committees

A. PERSONNEL COMMITTEE

A few more sections will be provided to the personal committee for review brought to the Board for approval. Employee training on the newly approved Employee Handbook will begin February 15, 2024.

J. Short Notice Items

K. Closed Session

CLOSED SESSION PURSUANT TO VA. CODE SECTION 2.2-3711(A)(1) TO DISCUSS AND CONSIDER PERSONNEL MATTERS; INCLUDING THE DISCIPLINE, APPOINTMENT, ASSIGNMENT, PERFORMANCE AND SALARIES OF SPECIFIC APPOINTEES AND EMPLOYEES.

Mr. _____ made a motion to close the regular open meeting and immediately reconvene in executive closed session to discuss and consider personnel matters; including the discipline, appointment, assignment, performance and salaries of specific appointees and employees. The motion was seconded by Mr. _____ and carried __-__.

RETURN TO OPEN MEETING:

Chairman Foster closed the closed session and immediately reconvened in regular open meeting at __:__ pm.

Chairman Foster read the following statement prior to the vote to certify the closed session.

"Pam will now poll members to certify that, to the best of your knowledge, only public business matters lawfully exempted from the open meeting requirements under the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, and as identified in the motion for which the closed meeting was convened, were discussed, and considered by the Board. If any member believes that the Board varied from the purpose stated for the closed meeting, please state so and the reason prior to casting the vote." A roll call vote was requested with the following results:

Mr. Foster
Mr. Smith
Mr. Filer
Mr. Hardy
Mr. Kies
Mr. Morgan
Mr. Wilson

The motion was carried __-__ among the members present.

Next meeting date - The next business meeting is scheduled March 13, 2024.

L. Adjournment

THERE BEING NO FURTHER BUSINESS, Mr. _____ made a motion to adjourn at __:__ pm. The motion was seconded by Mr. _____ and carried __-__ among the members present.

BY ORDER OF:

Judson Foster
Chairman
LOUISA COUNTY WATER AUTHORITY